

U.S. TROOPS KILLED AS BLASTS JOLT MIDEAST; FEAR OF WIDER WAR AFTER IRAN'S RESPONSE



TEHRAN A crowd chanted “death to America” and “death to Israel” at a rally to mourn the supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, killed in an airstrike. Iran’s top national security official said that an interim committee would run the country. Obituary, Page A8.



UNITED ARAB EMIRATES A warehouse in Sharjah City. Iran’s attacks on Persian Gulf countries hurt their images of safety. Page A12.



IRAN The death toll from a strike at a girls’ elementary school rose to at least 115 people, according to news media reports. Page A11.



ISRAEL Officials said that an Iranian missile strike killed at least nine people in Beit Shemesh, near Jerusalem. Page A10.



PAKISTAN At least 22 people were killed on Sunday as thousands gathered across the country to denounce U.S. and Israeli strikes.

Trump Says He’s Willing to Talk to Tehran’s New Leadership

This article is by **Aaron Boxerman, Farnaz Fassihi, Helene Cooper and Thomas Fuller.**

JERUSALEM — As the United States and Israel pounded Iran from land and sea for a second day, a defiant Iranian regime unleashed deadly retaliatory strikes across the Middle East on Sunday, amid fears of a wider, protracted conflagration.

Three U.S. troops were killed in Kuwait, the Pentagon said on Sunday, the first Americans to die in President Trump’s high-stakes war with Iran. And at least nine people were killed in a small Israeli city near Jerusalem. Explosions resounded in Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Oman and the United Arab Emirates, killing at least four people, as local air defenses sought to repel Iranian drones.

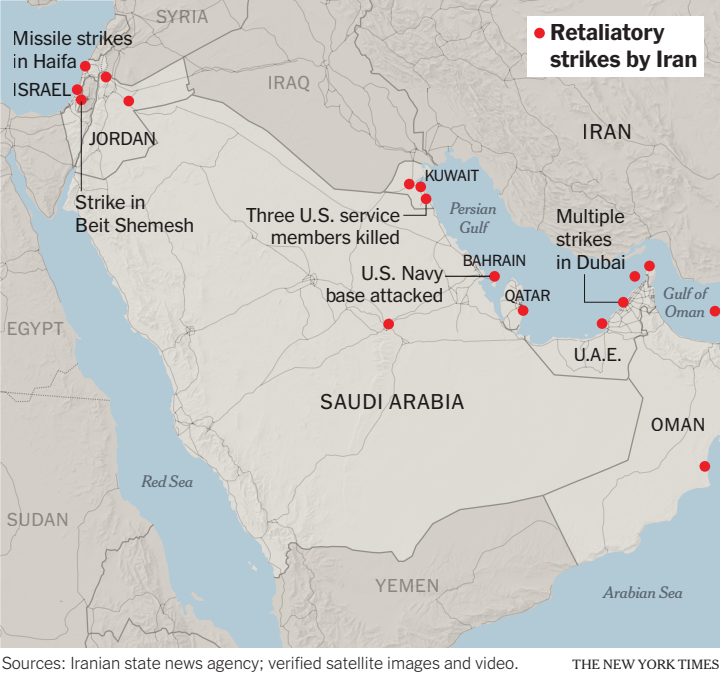
A day after Iranian media confirmed that the country’s supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, was among many top officials killed in an airstrike, Iran’s top national security official, Ali Larijani, announced that an interim committee would run the country until a successor to the ayatollah was chosen. Mr. Larijani also said that the supreme leader’s death would not deter Iran, which he said would hit Israeli and American targets “with a force they have never experienced before.”

The ability of the Iranian people to “take back your country,” as Mr. Trump said in the video recording on Sunday, remained an open question, with internal divisions displayed on city streets. Images from Iran showed large crowds gathering in Tehran and other cities early Sunday morning to celebrate the ayatollah’s death, lighting off fireworks and dancing. But hours later, scores of tearful mourners emerged to grieve his death, waving Iranian flags and holding photos of him.

In a phone interview on Sunday morning, Mr. Trump told The Atlantic magazine that Iran’s new leadership wanted to speak to him and that he was willing to do so. “They want to talk, and I have agreed to talk, so I will be talking to them,” he said from his residence in Florida. “They should have done it sooner. They should have given what was very practical and easy to do sooner. They waited too long,” he added.

The global consequences of the attack on Iran were only beginning to unfold on Sunday, with markets in Egypt and Saudi Arabia jolting downward, widespread flight cancellations and the prospect of prolonged convulsions in the global oil markets, especially for China, which sources a

Continued on Page A11



Once Foe of Regime Change, Trump Asserts Power Abroad

By **PETER BAKER**

WASHINGTON — When he first ran for president in 2016, Donald J. Trump disavowed the military adventurism of recent years, declaring that “regime change is a proven, absolute failure.” He promised to “stop racing to topple foreign regimes.”

When Mr. Trump ran for president in 2024, he boasted of starting “no new wars,” and asserted that if Kamala Harris won, “she would get us into a World War III guaranteed,” and send the “sons and daughters” of Americans “to go fight for a war in a country that you’ve never heard of.”

Barely a year later, Mr. Trump is racing to topple foreign regimes, and is sending American sons and daughters to wage another war in the Middle East. The self-declared “president of PEACE” has chosen to become the president of war after all, unleashing the full power of the U.S. military on Iran with the explicit goal of toppling its government.

What the Donald Trump of 2016 would think of the Donald

Continued on Page A6

Nostalgic Young Audience Rediscovered the iPod

By **KALLEY HUANG**

SAN FRANCISCO — About four years ago, Angeline Richard opened Apple Music, hoping to listen to the Weeknd’s cover of Drake’s “Trust Issues.”

“This song is not currently available in your country or region,” a pop-up read.

Ms. Richard, 25, continued discovering that other songs she loved or had added to her playlists were no longer available on the app.

Upset with the disappearing songs and ever-increasing prices of streaming services, she set a goal for this year: “To get off as many streaming services as possible, just so I can own the things that I listen to, that I read, that I watch.”

So in January, Ms. Richard bought a silver, third-generation iPod Nano from eBay for about \$40. She immediately added Deftones’ 2000 album, “White Pony,” to her iPod and has downloaded 10 more CDs to the device since. The process of adding music to her iPod, she said, has been

Seeking a Refuge From Phone Notifications and Social Media

“so fun” and “like a little meditation.”

Over the past month, Ms. Richard has found another upside to her iPod.

“If I’m on my phone, I’m listening to music, then I get a notification, I click on that notification and I keep going into different apps,” Ms. Richard, a content creator in Raleigh, N.C., said. The iPod “just grounds me, and it feels convenient to be in one place at one time, instead of everywhere at once.”

The iPod, introduced nearly 25 years ago and discontinued in 2022, is finding new fans among people who may not have even been born when it was first released.

Continued on Page A15

Doctors Served Epstein While Treating His ‘Girls’

This article is by **David A. Fahrenthold, Azeen Ghorayshi and Maggie Astor.**

A plastic surgeon from Mount Sinai closed a young woman’s head wound with 35 stitches on Jeffrey Epstein’s dining room table.

An internist in West Palm Beach ordered a blood test for another woman, then reported the abnormal results back to Mr. Epstein.

A dentist at Columbia University asked Mr. Epstein how much work he wanted done on a “girl” with severe tooth decay.

These providers were part of a small stable of loyal medical spe-

cialists cultivated and rewarded by Mr. Epstein, the convicted sex offender and financier who died in a jail cell in 2019. He often tapped their expertise for his own ailments, firing off questions about his bad back, high cholesterol and erectile dysfunction drugs. Sometimes, he connected them with his powerful friends in business and politics, even arranging one lawyer’s mammogram.

But Mr. Epstein also used the doctors to manipulate young women from overseas who were having sex with him, according to a tranche of Epstein-related documents released by the government in January.

He directed women to get pelvic exams, liposuction and mole removals, and paid for a range of specialty treatments, from \$800-an-hour psychiatric therapy to a root canal. Sometimes, he abruptly cut off the women’s care: An assistant once forwarded him a plea from a woman asking for \$600 to refill her prescription for acne medicine. “Ignore,” Mr. Epstein replied.

Continued on Page A19

Some in a V.I.P. Stable Broke the Rules and Profited, Files Show

cialists cultivated and rewarded by Mr. Epstein, the convicted sex offender and financier who died in a jail cell in 2019. He often tapped their expertise for his own ailments, firing off questions about his bad back, high cholesterol and erectile dysfunction drugs. Sometimes, he connected them with his powerful friends in business and politics, even arranging one lawyer’s mammogram.

